



ness as a far more positive thing, a rich source of creativity. As far as Jung was concerned, the dreams and feelings of human beings were as important in shaping their experiences as physical reality.

These myths that spring from the collective unconsciousness have universal truths embedded within them. The mythologies of stories all around the world have certain common elements, death and rebirth, a trickster god, or the dark side of humans that Jung called the shadow. There are no specific number of archetypes, and they can mix and intermingle. These themes are common even in modern day tales, as the steps of a hero's journey outlined by Joseph Campbell is replicated in a number of stories including Star Wars, Thor, Harry Potter and The Matrix. These heroes all go through trials, get help from a mentor, go into other realms, get a boon and become the masters of two worlds. A more detailed exploration of these similarities in modern fiction appears in the August 2019 infoporn. George Lucas used Campbells writings as a reference for creating Star Wars.

Jung changed the way psychologists look at the mind, as something that needed nurturing instead of a machine that needs to be oiled. Understanding these archetypes allows people to not only gain a deeper understanding of the stories all around us, but also why we like them so much. In *The Women who run with the Wolves*, Clarissa Pinkola Estes explains how the magic carpet is a metaphor for the sacred body. The fairy tales in which this flying carpet appears reflect our attitudes towards our own bodies. The carpets are typically thought of as ordinary, but once people sit on them, they begin to levitate then soar. In one story, a Sultan sends his three sons on a quest to gain the finest object on Earth. One brings back an ivory wand that allows the wielder to see anywhere, another brings back an apple that can be smelled to cure any disease, and a third brings back the



BOOKSHELF



The Hero with a Thousand Faces by Joseph Campbell

The definitive volume on comparative mythology and exploring the common aspects of stories around the world, as well as the archetypes and the waypoints that show up in all of these stories. Essential reading. Find the version with an introduction by Clarissa Pinkola Estes



The Women Who Run with the Wolves by Clarissa Pinkola Estés

This book is all about exploring a single archetype, that of the wild woman, and talks about how making sure of the health of that archetype is essentially for the good health of a woman. The book is unabashed about exploring the more esoteric and spiritual aspects of Jungian psychology.



Theorising Myth by Bruce Lincoln

This is a bird's eye view on how myths have been understood throughout history. At different times throughout history, these stories were derided, celebrated, appropriated by the cultural elite, or exploited for political gains. The book is a study on the study of mythology.



Pathways to Bliss by Joseph Campbell

The most distilled version of Campbell's philosophy, this volume is all about the function of myth for an individual, which is to provide a map towards bliss. Campbell explores the aspect of mythologies from the perspective of what an individual can take away or learn from them.



The Soul's Code by James Hillman

One of the practitioners of archetypal psychology, Hillman explains his theory on how the soul contains within itself the seed or acorn of its full potential, which will find its own way to go irrespective of the nature or nurture by the parents. This is an amusing and practical guide.

magic carpet. The Sultan proclaims all the objects are equal, and divides up his kingdom. This story shows how magical the human body is, even the mundane gifts of insight, healing and movement. Estes goes on to suggest then that the body is not some kind of mecha for the soul, it is not a suit that we wear. Instead it can be a wise and experienced teacher that can actually guide the soul, and should be treated as such, instead of as a slave that is made to merely execute the will of the mind.

The study of comparative mythology has such gems of wisdom, and they are not that difficult to understand once you get the idea of archetypes, and the fundamental understanding of how to interpret the themes and motifs in almost all stories. In the bookshelf section, we have noted all the essential reading that should get you on your way. Next month, we will be looking at the most common archetypes in mythologies and folk tales. We will also be exploring their meanings and purpose. ✎